

NIGERIA — WEEKLY THREAT BRIEF

Nigerian Military Counter-Insurgency Operating Environment

Reporting period: 31 August – 7 September 2026 (7 days) | Issued: Monday 7 September 2026. The week's defining event was a complex attack on the Gubio–Kareto–Damasak road on 3 September: an IED destroyed the armoured lead vehicle of a governorship candidate's convoy, and ISWAP followed it with a small-arms and RPG ambush. Multi-source. Inside the enclaves, the Boko Haram–ISWAP factional war reignited on the Chingolo axis of Sambisa with more than 23 killed. OPHK published its August totals, including ten air interdictions. And the South East produced its first anti-armour IED against troops in this brief's window, under an MRAP in Orsu, Imo. Background from the baseline assessment and earlier issues is not repeated.

1. Bottom Line Up Front

- An IED destroyed an armoured vehicle on the Kareto–Damasak road and ISWAP followed up with an RPG ambush — the week's most air-relevant item, and multi-source.** On Thursday 3 September the convoy of Mustapha Gubio, APC governorship candidate in Borno, was returning to Maiduguri from Damasak when the leading CRACK operational armoured vehicle ran over an IED on the Gubio–Kareto–Damasak road. The blast completely destroyed the vehicle. Suspected ISWAP fighters then attempted to exploit the strike with an ambush — The Sun reports RPGs alongside small arms — and troops, police tactical operatives and CJTF took defensive positions, engaged, and drove them into the bush before clearing the area for secondary devices. No casualties among the entourage. Four things matter for an air unit. First, a device capable of destroying an armoured vehicle is a step up from the pressure-plate and command devices that have been damaging MRAPs on the Dikwa–Marte belt. Second, IED-then-ambush is a deliberate template: the device fixes the target and the ambush kills what comes to help — which is the QRF, and often the air support. Third, this is the Kareto–Damasak corridor in northern Borno, adjacent to the Kukawa axis where the strike tempo has been concentrated all month. Fourth, the 2027 election cycle has started generating convoys: predictable, high-value, publicly announced movements that will draw both enemy planning and air-support tasking. Confirmed by Zagazola, Vanguard, Businessday, The Sun and the Borno police command; note the timing discrepancy — Zagazola reports Thursday evening, police and most outlets ~14:30.
- The Boko Haram–ISWAP factional war reignited in Sambisa: more than 23 killed on the Chingolo axis.** Fighting resumed around 2 September when ISWAP elements moved into the Chingolo axis of Bama LGA and Boko Haram attacked the advancing group; Zagazola reports sustained exchanges of fire, obtained video, and preliminary intelligence of 23+ killed on both sides, with per-faction figures unverified. This is operationally significant beyond the body count: two mutually hostile armed forces are now manoeuvring in the same enclave belt. A concentration of armed men in Sambisa may be a battle rather than a target set, positive identification is harder, and movement that looks like reinforcement may be withdrawal from a rival. It is also a collection opportunity — factional fighting produces surrenders, and the Mafa surrender reported last week was officially attributed to exactly this.
- OPHK published its August scorecard: 152 neutralised, 142 arrested, 219 surrendered — and ten air interdictions.** Operational data obtained by Zagazola for August 2026 across the North East theatre: 152 terrorists neutralised, 142 suspects arrested, 219 surrendered, 10 air interdictions flown and 9 IEDs neutralised. Recoveries: 58 weapons and explosive items including AK-47 and AK-49 rifles, locally fabricated firearms, a hand grenade and an RPG bomb; 1,184 rounds of ammunition; 16 mobility assets; 44 mobile phones; and ₦1,794,910 in cash. Two readings. Ten air interdictions in thirty-one days is roughly one every three days — that is the planning tempo, and it is sustained rather than surging. And surrenders outnumbering kills by 219 to 152 is the more interesting number: it points to an enemy under pressure and fragmenting, which is consistent with the Sambisa factional fighting. Note also what is absent — the aggregate itemises an RPG bomb and a hand grenade but does not call

out the two anti-aircraft rounds reported recovered at Kadiya on 29 August. That is a reason to keep chasing the calibre, not a reason to drop the indicator.

- **Force protection holds at fourteen weeks with nothing employed against aircraft — but the anti-armour IED threat migrated to the South East.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS employment, no GPS or EW interference and no aircraft or UAV losses, verified again by search this week. Separately, at 06:50 on 4 September an IED detonated under an MRAP of 34 Artillery Brigade during a routine patrol on the Ihite Ukwá–Health Centre axis in Orsu LGA, Imo. The front-right fender was damaged; no casualties. That is the first anti-armour device employed against troops in the South East inside this brief's rolling window, and it moves the South East from raids, arrests and static camps to devices emplaced on military patrol routes. Imo goes 2 → 3 on the heatmap. Orsu sits on the Imo–Anambra ESN seam next to the Ihiala 'Mother Valley' axis where eleven devices were cleared on 20 August.
- **REGIONAL — Niamey's mutiny is now assessed as an attempted coup, and Tillabéri is being hit while the regime looks inward.** The 29 August action against Air Base 101 (co-located with Diori Hamani International) is now characterised as a coup attempt by a faction styling itself the Armed Forces for the Restoration of the Fatherland, drawing on soldiers from Ouallam, Téra and Dosso; reported cost is at least 27 dead and around 100 mutineers arrested, with Russian Africa Corps personnel involved in retaking the base. Within days, armed assailants attacked Darbani, Diamballa and Namarigoungou in Tillabéri on 2 September and Zibane in Anzourou commune on 3 September, with civilian deaths including two girls drowned while fleeing. On 4 September Niamey publicly blamed France for instigating the mutiny without producing evidence. ISSP is on pace for record attack numbers in Tillabéri and in Dosso — and Dosso borders Nigeria's north-west. Assume unpredictable Nigerien airspace management for several more weeks, and expect the Kebbi–Sokoto–Niger seam to absorb pressure while Niamey is distracted.

2. North East Developments

Window note: a different shape of week. No base assault was reported against a fixed position in the theatre — the Kadiya-type attack did not repeat — but the enemy demonstrated a more capable roadside technique against a moving target, and the internal war inside the enclaves resumed. The visible air component was quieter in the reporting than in recent weeks: no individual precision strike was reported inside 31 August – 6 September, with the air picture instead arriving as an August aggregate. Treat the absence of strike reporting as a reporting gap rather than a confirmed pause.

Gubio–Kareto–Damasak, 3 September — the complex attack

Detail as at Section 1. What is worth extracting for tasking: the device was sited on a highway used by a security-escorted convoy, it was effective against armour rather than merely disabling, and the follow-on ambush was mounted quickly enough to suggest the ambush party was already in position rather than reacting. Post-incident, security forces held the route and cleared for secondary devices — a sensible drill and one worth assuming the enemy now expects. For rotary support, the practical implication is that a call to a struck convoy on this corridor should be treated as a possible prepared engagement area, not simply a casualty pickup. The Damasak axis has been repeatedly flagged as vulnerable; this raises the demonstrated capability there.

Factional war resumes on the Chingolo axis, Bama LGA

Detail as at Section 1. Zagazola describes the current round as beginning about two days before its 4 September report, triggered by an ISWAP move into Chingolo. Both factions are described as trying to consolidate positions and deny the other expansion within the forest. Security sources say the forces are monitoring and exploiting intelligence on the movements of both. This remains a

single-chain account, but it now sits alongside last week's official OPHK attribution of a Mafa surrender to factional clashes, which makes the underlying pattern harder to dismiss.

Lassa raided again — and residents report no military response

Overnight on 29–30 August, Boko Haram raided Sabon Gari in Lassa Ward, Askira-Uba LGA — the same ward from which 36 students and a teacher were abducted on 29 June. TruthNigeria reporting quotes residents saying more than 50 shops were looted and 15 burned, with sewing machines, groceries and business equipment taken and six people injured; the attack lasted about three hours and residents say there was no military response during it. A former federal representative for the constituency, Hon. Tarpaya Asarya, publicly confirmed and condemned the attack. The claim of a three-hour unopposed raid is residents' testimony, not an established fact, and no military account has been published — but a three-hour window is precisely the kind of response-time gap that air support exists to close, and it is worth asking through the ground chain what the actual response picture was.

Kukawa follow-through and the counter-network fight

- **Continued exploitation on the Kadiya axis.** 101 Special Forces Battalion recovered a motorcycle and blood-stained clothing during exploitation of the failed Kukawa attack (reported 2 September), and subsequently recovered three decomposing bodies assessed to be fighters who were wounded during the same foiled attack and died while withdrawing (reported 5 September). The same battalion arrested a 60-year-old suspected ISWAP spy on the Cross-Kukawa road. Exploitation of that engagement has now run for more than a week — a reminder that battle-damage assessment in this theatre keeps accruing well after the strike.
- **Surrenders continue at scale.** 25 terrorist family members surrendered in separate incidents in Borno; two teenage members surrendered to Sector 3 OPHK in Monguno; and two brothers surrendered to 25 Brigade in Damboa. This is consistent with the 219 August surrender figure and with enclave fragmentation.
- **Counter-network arrests.** 29 Task Force Brigade with Forest Guards and CJTF arrested a suspected collaborator and logistics supplier carrying medical supplies; Headquarters Sector 3 OPHK arrested four further suspects in Monguno including a tax collector; 154 Task Force Battalion arrested a suspected informant at Ngamdu, Kaga LGA. Medical resupply and taxation are the two functions that most reliably indicate a governance structure rather than a raiding party.
- **Gwoza rescues and Yobe contact.** 82 Division Task Force Battalion rescued a young female abductee (04:41 on 4 September), a 42-year-old woman who had escaped her captors, and an 11-year-old girl allegedly taken from her community for a spying mission — all in Gwoza LGA. In Yobe, 120 Task Force Battalion with the CJTF killed a terrorist and recovered an AK-47 in an ambush in Gujba LGA, and a separate attack on a Yobe location was repelled.

Schools thread — day 115 and day 70, and the rescue effort is now on the record

No release, negotiation or proof-of-life reporting surfaced this window for the Mussa pupils (taken 15 May) or the 36 Lassa students and one staff member (taken 29 June) — 78 children and one teacher in total, though some reporting puts the Mussa cohort at 44 rather than 42 and the discrepancy is unresolved. What is new is attribution: OPHK has now formally stated, in a release signed by Captain Mohammed Goni, that the 27 August Kopre Mountain camp assault in Hong LGA was conducted 'in furtherance of sustained efforts to locate and rescue' the Mussa and Lassa children. The assaulting force is named as an Office of the National Security Adviser tactical team together with newly inducted troops of 226 Battalion deployed to Sector 4 in Adamawa. Last week this brief carried Kopre Mountain as a camp-destruction item; it should now be read as a rescue operation that did not find the hostages.

3. Air / ISR & Force-Protection Watch Items

- **Brief crews on the IED-then-ambush template, not just the IED.** The Kareto–Damasak attack is the clearest demonstration in this window of a two-phase design: a device effective against armour, followed immediately by a direct-fire ambush including RPGs. Whether or not the enemy intended to draw in air support, that is the effect the template produces. Practical steps: treat a call to a struck convoy on the Gubio–Kareto–Damasak or Damasak–Gorom corridors as a contested-area task from the outset; expect secondary devices and a prepared ambush position rather than a clear pickup; and factor RPG range into approach and hold profiles on that axis. Convoy-support and CASEVAC tasking around election movement is the most likely way this reaches our aircraft.
- **Positive identification in the Sambisa belt just got harder.** With Boko Haram and ISWAP fighting each other on the Chingolo axis of Bama LGA, a group of armed men in the enclave belt is no longer reliably one adversary. For strike support this raises the identification burden, and it also means observed movement may be lateral repositioning between factions rather than reinforcement toward friendly forces. Worth confirming with the theatre how factional deconfliction — if that is even the right word — is being handled in target validation over the Sambisa/Chingolo axis.
- **Air interdiction tempo: ten in August, roughly one every three days.** The OPHK August aggregate gives the first published tempo figure this brief has been able to cite. Ten interdictions plus nine IEDs neutralised over the month is a steady, intelligence-led rhythm rather than a surge. Plan resupply, crew duty and maintenance against that, and note that no individual strike was reported in open sources during 31 August – 6 September, which is more likely a reporting gap than a stand-down.
- **The Kadiya anti-aircraft rounds: no corroboration this week. Keep the indicator open, lower the volume.** Nothing further has surfaced on the two AAA-calibre rounds reported recovered at Kadiya on 29 August, and the OPHK August aggregate — which does itemise an RPG bomb and a hand grenade — does not mention them. That is weakly negative evidence. The standing assumption remains 'no AAA employment observed; AAA-calibre ammunition reported present in the Kukawa area, single-source and unconfirmed.' Keep seeking the calibre through the ground chain, and continue to treat any tracer, airburst or further recovery as a priority report.
- **Intra-theatre lift is running at scale — and it is a pattern worth thinking about.** The COAS welfare flight moved 350 personnel into and out of the North East theatre this week. For our purposes this means competition for ramp space, slots and ground handling at Maiduguri, and it is worth confirming how welfare-flight scheduling interacts with our own tasking. It is also a standing observation that a recurring, high-density, publicly reported personnel movement is a readable pattern; that is a question for the supported command rather than a finding, but it belongs on the list.
- **Regional airspace: Niamey is worse than last week, not better.** The 29 August action at Air Base 101 is now described as an attempted coup rather than a mutiny, with at least 27 dead and around 100 arrests, and the regime has publicly blamed France. Tillabéri attacks resumed within seventy-two hours. Continue to assume unpredictable Nigerien airspace management, possible short-notice closures or NOTAM activity, and heightened border sensitivity. Nigeria–Niger intelligence sharing has been blocked since 2023; an internally destabilised Niamey makes cross-border deconfliction harder still, precisely while ISSP pressure builds on the Dosso side of the seam.
- **Threat systems: nothing employed — fourteen weeks.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no GPS or EW interference, no aircraft or UAV losses. The last documented armed-drone use against a Nigerian base remains Sabon Gari, Damboa (late January 2026); the last confirmed airframe loss remains the 2 January CH-4 (technical failure, Kontagora). The

standing caution is unchanged, and the Kareto–Damasak device is a reminder of the direction of travel: this enemy is investing in explosive effects against protected targets. Reporting from February 2026 that ISWAP received a batch of about 35 drones through the Lake Chad corridor into the Timbuktu Triangle and Sambisa axis remains standing background — unemployed to date, not disproved.

- **US dimension — no new activity, and a political development that could move it either way.** No new AFRICOM announcements concerning Nigeria this window. Standing posture, for deconfliction purposes: roughly 200 US personnel have been deployed in advisory and training roles since 10 February 2026 with elements at Maiduguri, Kainji and Bauchi, MQ-9 Reapers have been reported deployed, and a US–Nigeria intelligence fusion cell was established; Nigerian DHQ has stated the American personnel are restricted to non-combat roles. The last US kinetic action remains the December 2025 Bauni Forest strikes and the May 2026 coordinated strikes. What changed this week is the narrative underneath the policy: BBC Africa Eye published 'Nigeria: Faith, Fear and Fake News' on 3–4 September, questioning the 'Christian genocide' framing that underpinned the October 2025 Country of Particular Concern designation and the associated military threat, and finding the violence considerably more complex — including Muslim victims in the Angwan Rukuba, Jos attack that was widely presented as evidence of a coordinated anti-Christian campaign. Congressional sanctions legislation remains live. This is worth tracking because US posture in Nigeria is politically driven, and a shift in the framing can move the presence and the airspace picture in either direction.
- **Information integrity: the fact-checking fight has gone mainstream.** The BBC investigation is itself the week's principal information-environment event, and it centres on disputed casualty data and the amplification of unverified claims. Zagazola separately carried a piece on social-media campaigns against a serving senator over banditry allegations. The operating rule is unchanged and now better evidenced: treat any loss, shoot-down, casualty or atrocity claim involving air assets as unverified until confirmed through the chain, and be aware that both inflation and denial are active in this space.

4. Other Theatres in Brief

- **North West — sustained pressure, useful recoveries, no barracks attack this week.** COAS Intervention Battalion 7 under Sector 2 Op FANSAN YAMMA dislodged terrorist elements in Sokoto and recovered a PKT machine gun, rifles, ammunition and motorcycles — a crew-served weapon recovery is a meaningful capability subtraction. 8 Task Force Group Administration Battalion with vigilantes recovered a locally fabricated AK-47 and six rounds in Rabah LGA. In Katsina, troops killed a terrorist commander's lieutenant and two named kingpins (31 August), neutralised a terrorist in a dawn offensive in Dan Musa, foiled a bandit attack and rescued three kidnapped victims on the Dandume–Sheme road, and rescued two abductees in Sabuwa. Op FANSAN YAMMA rescued 23 abducted civilians in Zamfara and intercepted a suspected ammunition courier across Zamfara and Kaduna; twelve rustled cattle were recovered in Danko-Wasagu, Kebbi. On the governance side, the Sokoto state government dethroned fifteen district heads over security-related offences and placed four more on a watchlist.
- **North Central / Middle Belt — Plateau volume remains extreme; the reciprocal cycle continues.** Killings this window: two people killed when local gunmen rustled cattle at Kopnale, Mangun District, Mangu; two locals killed on sentry duty at Rim, Riyom, attributed to Fulani bandits; one killed and one injured between Gaude and Mangu Halle; a motorcyclist killed by suspected militia on the Nyong–Bodel road, Bokkos. Abductions: a Cottage Hospital matron, Mrs Sarah Dalang, taken in Bokkos, prompting a Sector 5 rescue operation; a 45-year-old woman rescued shortly after being kidnapped at Ngorot, Bokkos; three kidnappers arrested and ₦3.5m recovered in a Riyom forest. Against herders and in mediation: a Berom militia

attack foiled at Zakaret, Barkin Ladi; 42 rustled cattle recovered in Mangu and returned; 112 rustled cattle voluntarily released on the Plateau–Bauchi border after military peace efforts in Kanam and Wase; repeated cattle interceptions and farmer–herder mediations across Bassa, Jos East, Barkin Ladi and Pankshin. The GOC 3 Division and Commander OPEP, Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, visited traditional and Fulani leaders pledging stronger peacebuilding. One internal-discipline item worth noting: troops arrested a serving soldier with 69 rounds of ammunition and other military items at Babale checkpoint, Jos North — ammunition leakage from inside the force is a recurring feeder of the civilian threat. Elsewhere, Op WHIRL STROKE neutralised a bandit on the Gbise–Igyudu road and rescued three kidnap victims at Tse Ogar, Gwer West in Benue, and raided a hideout at Peva, Takum in Taraba arresting five; troops rescued two female kidnap victims in Dekina, Kogi; a farmer–herder clash was foiled at Nok, Jaba LGA in Kaduna, where an informant was also arrested in Sanga.

- **South East — the level change: an anti-armour IED under an MRAP in Imo.** Detail as at Section 1. Alongside it, 144 Battalion arrested a suspected IPOB member waving a Biafra flag on patrol in Aba South, Abia. One item with an aviation flavour: 24 Special Engineer Regiment arrested a woman in Ebonyi for impersonating a Nigerian Air Force officer — trivial in itself, but uniform and identity impersonation is a known access technique and worth a line in the access-control brief. Anambra holds 3; with the governorship cycle live, expect South East tempo to rise rather than settle, and the Orsu device suggests the method is changing as well as the rate.
- **Niger Delta / Gulf of Guinea — thirteenth consecutive quiet week for militancy; enforcement continues.** No new pipeline or maritime attack claims. JTF South South Op DELTA SAFE arrested a suspected illegal bunkerer and intercepted about 100 litres of illegally refined condensate in Delta; 90 Amphibious Battalion with the NDLEA arrested five suspected drug peddlers in Sapele; 2 Brigade Garrison troops at HITECH 1 on the Uyo–Oron road arrested five suspected fuel thieves in Nsit Atai, Akwa Ibom.
- **Regional and political weather — Niamey dominates; the genocide-narrative dispute goes mainstream.** Beyond Tillabéri and the coup-attempt reframing (Sections 1 and 3): the BBC Africa Eye documentary has moved the disputed-casualty-data argument into mainstream international coverage, with knock-on effects for US policy framing. Domestically, troops rescued the wife of a retired brigadier-general in the FCT and arrested two kidnappers; Nigeria's UN permanent representative reaffirmed that the country has no nuclear weapons or WMD programme. Two armed-kidnapping incidents in the South West — a rescue with an AK-47 recovered in Ogun on 1 September and a rescue with a suspect killed in Epe, Lagos — are noted but not enough for a heatmap level change. No gubernatorial changes this week.

5. Country Activity Heatmap (last 3 months)

The two views below summarise assessed security activity across all 36 states and the FCT over roughly the last three months ($\approx$ early June – 7 September 2026). The choropleth shows each state's dominant incident type (fill colour) and intensity (shade depth and number); the matrix breaks activity down by incident type. This is an indicative qualitative assessment for orientation — synthesised from open-source reporting, not a counted event dataset such as ACLED. ONE level change this issue: Imo 2 $\rightarrow$ 3, dominant type unchanged at separatist, on the 4 September IED detonation under a 34 Artillery Brigade MRAP on the Ihite Ukwa–Health Centre axis in Orsu LGA — the first anti-armour device employed against troops in the South East inside the window, and a method shift from raids and arrests to devices on military patrol routes. Everything else holds. Borno holds 4 but is heavily reinforced (the Kareto–Damasak armoured-vehicle IED and ambush, the Chingolo factional battle, the Sabon Gari/Lassa raid, continuing Kukawa exploitation). Adamawa holds 3 with no new event — the Kopre Mountain raid is now understood as a schools-rescue operation. Plateau holds 4 on sustained very high volume and moderate lethality. Sokoto, Katsina and Zamfara hold 4 on continued Fansan Yamma pressure including a PKT machine gun recovery.

Niger and Benue hold 4; Kaduna, Kebbi, Kogi and Anambra hold 3; Kwara and Yobe hold 2; Delta holds 2 on a thirteenth quiet militancy week; Jigawa and Osun hold 1. Noted but not levelled: armed kidnapping in Lagos and Ogun — one week of routine crime is not a three-month level change.

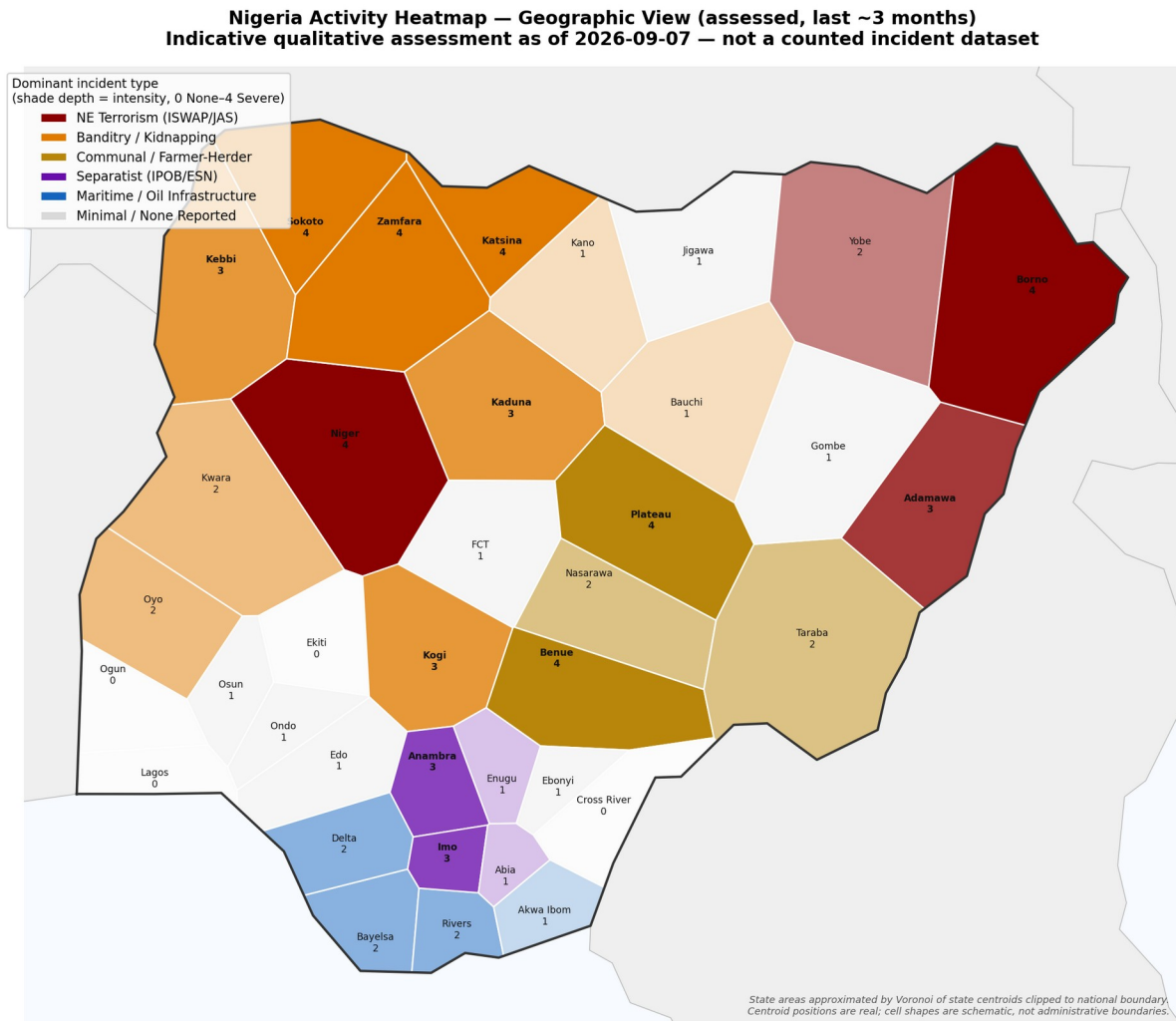


Figure 1 — Activity choropleth on a Natural Earth basemap (Nigeria + neighbours). Fill = dominant incident type; shade depth & number = intensity (0 None-4 Severe). State areas are approximated by Voronoi of state centroids clipped to the national boundary — centroid positions are real, cell shapes schematic. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Incident Type by State (assessed, last ~3 months)
States grouped by geopolitical zone — indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-09-07, not a counted dataset

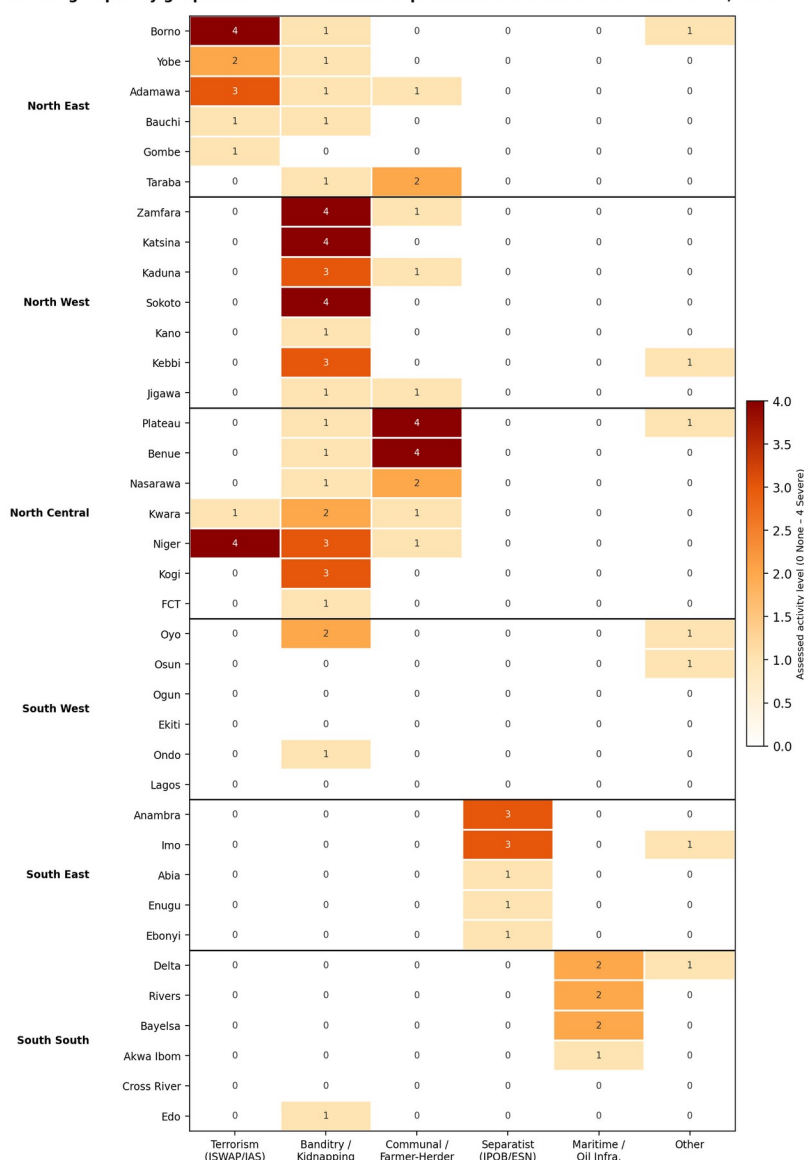


Figure 2 — Incident type by state (states grouped by geopolitical zone). Cell value/shade = assessed activity level, 0 None–4 Severe. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

6. Events Map — UCDP (curated) & GDELT (news-derived)

Two-panel figure from this morning's scheduled daily map run (7 September; GDELT ingested through 6 September). LEFT PANEL: no new UCDP release has landed for a second consecutive week, so the most recent seven days of curated data remain 25–31 July 2026 — unchanged at 29 events and 174 best-estimate fatalities (57 civilian). The lag has therefore widened to roughly five and a half weeks. Read the left panel as verified late-July pattern, not as this week's ground truth, and note that two consecutive weeks without a release means the gap will close abruptly when one lands. RIGHT PANEL: news-derived GDELT events for the actual last seven days (31 August – 6 September 2026: 363 machine-coded events from ~3,055 articles, deduplicated and cross-checked against UCDP) — down from 420 last week and 447 the week before, a second consecutive weekly fall in reporting volume. GDELT is timely but noisy: locations and event types are machine-extracted and individual dots are not verified incidents; a falling count reflects press attention, not necessarily falling violence. Cross-referenced against Sections 1–4, expect clusters on the northern Borno corridor around Gubio, Kareto and Damasak, the Bama/Chingolo axis of Sambisa, Askira-

Uba around Lassa, Kukawa, a dense and diffuse Plateau signature across Bokkos, Riyom, Mangu, Jos and Bassa, Katsina and Zamfara across the Fansas Yamma AOR, and an Orsu/Imo marker in the South East. Read the panels together: UCDP for verified pattern, GDELT for current tempo and geography.

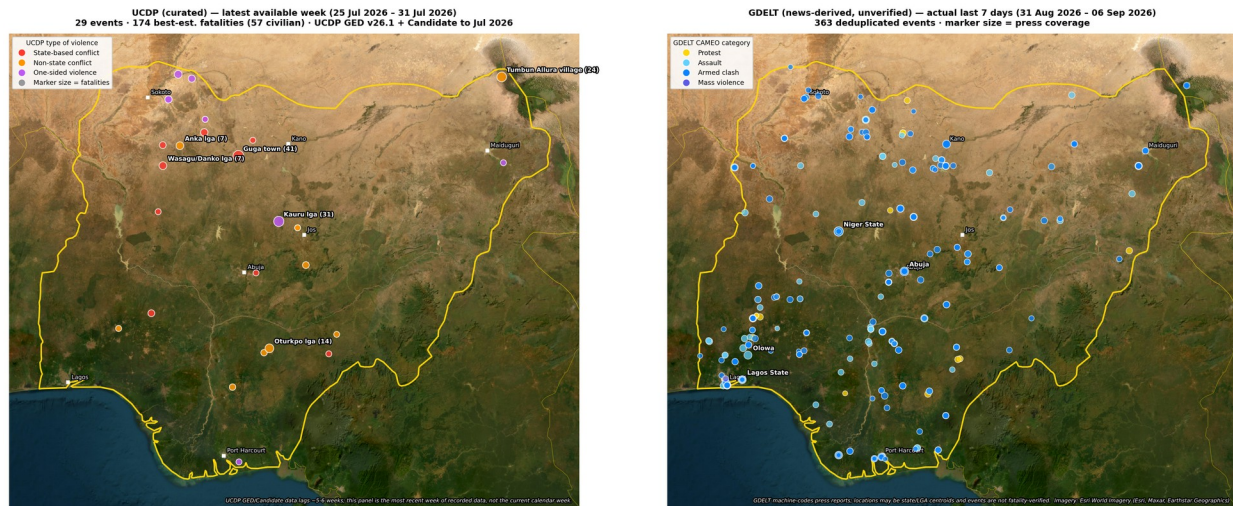


Figure 3 — Left: UCDP-recorded conflict events, most recent 7 days of available curated data (25–31 July 2026; lags ~5½ weeks — NOT current-week ground truth). Right: GDELT news-derived events for 31 August – 6 September 2026 — machine-coded from press reporting, deduplicated, unverified; indicative of current reporting tempo only. Rendered 7 September 2026 from the daily-updated Nigeria Events Map.

Interactive map: <https://rbmglobal.co.uk/nigeria-activity-map/>

7. Sources

Open-source reporting consulted 7 September 2026. Military and government figures are flagged as claims throughout. Two-source or better this window: the Kareto–Damasak IED and ambush on the Gubio convoy (Zagazola, Vanguard, Businessday, The Sun, Blueprint and the Borno police command — independent chains, though they differ on timing, with Zagazola reporting Thursday evening and police reporting ~14:30, and on attribution, with some outlets saying Boko Haram where Zagazola says ISWAP); the OPHK Kopre Mountain rescue-operation statement (official OPHK release via TruthNigeria, alongside last week's Zagazola account); the Niamey coup attempt and its aftermath (Al Jazeera, Critical Threats/AEI Africa File, Egmont Institute, Zagazola); and the BBC Africa Eye documentary (BBC, via Sahara Reporters and PRNigeria). Effectively single-chain (Zagazola security sources or military sources) and unverified: the Chingolo factional battle and its 23+ claimed killed, the OPHK August operational aggregate, the Kukawa exploitation recoveries, and most Plateau, Katsina, Zamfara and Kaduna minor items. The Sabon Gari/Lassa raid rests on resident testimony collected by TruthNigeria, including the claim that there was no military response during the three-hour attack — that claim is uncorroborated and no military account has been published. Date-verification note: several recirculated items surfaced in searches and were excluded as not current — the April 2026 Yobe market airstrike and the December 2025 Kukawa civilian-casualty strike (both returned by a September-2026 Borno airstrike query); the January 2026 CH-4 loss near Kontagora (returned again by a September-2026 aircraft-loss query); the 21–22 August Aduwa and Buratai strikes, which belong to a previous window and are referenced here only inside the August aggregate; and the February 2026 reporting on the US troop deployment, the MQ-9 deployment and the ISWAP 35-drone batch, all cited as standing background rather than current-week reporting.

North East, air campaign & the Kareto–Damasak attack

- [Borno APC candidate, Gubio attacked by ISWAP as security forces repel deadly ambush \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Gubio–Kareto–Damasak road, 3 Sep; CRACK armoured vehicle destroyed by IED; follow-on ambush repelled by troops, police and CJTF; no convoy casualties)
- [Boko Haram terrorists attack APC gov candidate's convoy in Borno \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Vanguard (independent chain; attribution given as Boko Haram)
- [Terrorists attack Borno APC candidate's convoy with IED, RPGs \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — The Sun (RPGs employed in the follow-on ambush; Kareto area, ~14:30)
- [Security operatives repel terrorists' attack on Borno APC guber candidate Gubio's convoy \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Businessday (police tactical operatives cleared secondary explosive threats; convoy evacuated)
- [EXCLUSIVE: Dozens of terrorists killed as Boko Haram, ISWAP fighters clash in Sambisa Forest \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Chingolo axis, Bama LGA; 23+ claimed killed on both sides; video obtained; single-chain)
- [Operation Hadin Kai intensifies campaign against ISWAP, Boko Haram, records major gains in August \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (August aggregate: 152 neutralised, 142 arrested, 219 surrendered, 10 air interdictions, 9 IEDs neutralised, 58 weapons incl. an RPG bomb, 1,184 rounds)
- [Rescue Operation for Kidnapped Nigerian Pupils Leads To Killing Of 22 Terrorists \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — TruthNigeria (official OPHK statement by Capt Mohammed Goni framing the 27 Aug Kopre Mountain assault as a schools-rescue operation by an ONSA tactical team with newly inducted 226 Bn, Sector 4; plus the 29–30 Aug Sabon Gari/Lassa raid — 50+ shops looted, 15 burned, residents report no military response)
- [Troops recover three decomposing terrorist bodies after foiled attack in Borno \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (101 Special Forces Bn, Kukawa LGA; continuing exploitation of the 28–29 Aug engagement)
- [Troops recover motorcycle, blood-stained clothing after failed terrorist attack in Kukawa \(2 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (101 Special Forces Bn exploitation)
- [Troops arrest suspected ISWAP spy along Cross-Kukawa road in Borno \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (101 Special Forces Bn)
- [25 ISWAP family members surrender to troops in Borno \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (consistent with the 219 August surrender figure)
- [Troops arrest suspected terrorist logistics supplier, recover medical supplies in Borno \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (29 Task Force Brigade with Forest Guards and CJTF)
- [Troops arrest four suspected terrorists, collaborators in Monguno \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (HQ Sector 3 OPHK; a tax collector among those held)
- [Troops arrest suspected terrorist informant in Ngamdu, Borno \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (154 Task Force Bn, Kaga LGA)
- [Troops rescue 11-year-old girl from suspected terrorist spying mission in Borno \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (82 Division Task Force Bn, Gwoza LGA; two further Gwoza rescues the same window)
- [Troops ambush, neutralise terrorist and recover AK-47 rifle in Yobe \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (120 Task Force Bn with CJTF, Gujba LGA)

Air, ISR & force protection

- [COAS welfare flight moves 350 personnel in and out of North-East theatre \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (intra-theatre lift at scale; ramp and slot implications at Maiduguri)
- [IED detonates under military vehicle during patrol in Imo \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (34 Artillery Bde MRAP, Ihite Ukwa–Health Centre axis, Orsu LGA, 06:50 on 4 Sep; front-right fender damaged, no casualties)

- [Nigeria loses CH-4 drone \(Jan 2026 — standing reference, NOT current\)](#) — *Military Africa* (last confirmed airframe loss: NAF-114, propulsion failure near Kontagora, 2 Jan 2026)
- [US deploys MQ-9 drones and troops to Nigeria for intelligence support \(Apr 2026 — standing background\)](#) — *Military Africa* (~200 US personnel from 10 Feb 2026 at Maiduguri, Kainji and Bauchi; MQ-9 Reapers; US–Nigeria intelligence fusion cell; non-combat mandate per Nigerian DHQ)
- [US deploys 100 soldiers to Nigeria as attacks by armed groups surge \(16 Feb 2026 — standing background\)](#) — *Al Jazeera* (independent chain on the same deployment)
- [ISWAP terrorists acquire more drones, plan coordinated attacks on Nigerian troops \(Feb 2026 — standing background\)](#) — *Premium Times* (~35 drones reported moved through the Lake Chad corridor; no employment observed since)
- [U.S. Africa Command press releases \(standing reference\)](#) — AFRICOM (no new Nigeria strike announcements in window)

Regional — Niger, Sahel

- [Niger: Fresh attacks in Tillabéri follow mutiny in Niamey \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Darbani, Diamballa and Namarigoungou attacked 2 Sep; Zibane, Anzourou 3 Sep; Base 101 near Diori Hamani International; Africa Corps assisted suppression)
- [Niger: Junta blames Macron after mutiny as security challenges persist \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Niamey blamed France on 4 Sep without published evidence)
- [Niger Thwarts Coup — Africa File, 3 September 2026](#) — *Critical Threats / AEI* (coup attempt by the 'Armed Forces for the Restoration of the Fatherland'; ≥27 dead, ~100 arrested; ISSP on pace for record attacks in Tillabéri and Dosso)
- [Niger's military-led government says it contained mutiny: What next? \(30 Aug 2026\)](#) — *Al Jazeera* (independent chain, standing reference from last window)

Information environment

- [BBC Africa Eye Investigation Questions 'Christian Genocide' Narrative In Nigeria, Finds Complex Web Of Violence \(3–4 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Sahara Reporters on the BBC documentary 'Nigeria: Faith, Fear and Fake News' (27 minutes; disputed casualty data; Angwan Rukuba, Jos case study found Muslim victims among the dead)*
- [BBC Africa Eye Challenges 'Christian Genocide' Claims, Unravels Complex Drivers of Nigeria's Violence \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PRNigeria* (independent chain)

North West

- [Troops dislodge terrorists, recover PKT machine gun, rifles, motorcycles in Sokoto \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (COAS Intervention Bn 7, Sector 2 Op Fansan Yamma; crew-served weapon recovery)
- [Troops kill terrorist commander's lieutenant in Katsina, recover weapons in clearance operation \(31 Aug 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola*
- [Troops rescue 23 abducted civilians, foil kidnapping attempt in Zamfara \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Op Fansan Yamma)
- [Troops neutralise terrorists, intercept ammunition courier in Zamfara, Kaduna \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (JTF North West; NW ammunition-flow thread)
- [Troops recover locally fabricated AK-47 rifle abandoned by terrorists in Sokoto \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (8 Task Force Group Administration Bn, Rabah LGA)

Middle Belt

- [Two killed as local gunmen rustle cattle in Plateau \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Kopnale, Mangun District, Mangu LGA)

- [Troops secure community after Fulani bandits killed two locals on sentry duty in Plateau \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Rim, Riyom LGA; Sector 6 OPEP)
- [Troops launch rescue operation after hospital matron kidnapped in Plateau \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Cottage Hospital, Bokkos; Sector 5 OPEP)
- [Troops arrest soldier, recover 69 rounds of ammunition in Plateau \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Babale Checkpoint, Jos North; internal ammunition-leakage indicator)
- [Local criminal elements release 112 rustled cattle in Plateau \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Plateau–Bauchi border, Kanam and Wase LGAs; military peace effort)
- [GOC 3 Division visits traditional, Fulani leaders, pledges stronger peacebuilding in Plateau \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, Comd OPEP)
- [Operation Whirl Stroke troops raid suspected terrorist hideout, arrest five in Taraba \(3 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Peva, Takum LGA)
- [Troops foil kidnapping, rescue three victims in Benue \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Sector 1 OPWS, Tse Ogar, Gwer West LGA)

South East, South South & national

- [Troops arrest suspected IPOB member waving Biafra flag in Abia \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (144 Battalion, Aba South LGA)
- [Troops arrest female impostor posing as Air Force officer in Ebonyi \(4 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (24 Special Engineer Regiment; identity-impersonation access risk)
- [Troops arrest suspected illegal bunkerer, seize 100 litres of refined condensate in Delta \(5 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (JTF South South, Op Delta Safe)
- [Troops arrest five suspected fuel thieves in Akwa Ibom \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (2 Brigade Garrison, HITECH 1, Uyo–Oron road, Nsit Atai LGA)
- [Army troops rescue retired general's wife, arrest two kidnappers in Abuja \(2 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (FCT)

Annex A — State Governors, Ethnic Affiliation & Principal Army Formations

Standing annex — changes since the 31 August issue are summarised here. NO GUBERNATORIAL CHANGE, NO DEFECTIONS and NO NEW GOC APPOINTMENTS this issue: the July 2026 slate (Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, 9 Div Ilorin; Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife, 10 Div Jalingo; Maj Gen Moses Gara, 5 Div Makurdi; Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda, 2 Div Ibadan) stands, and searches this week returned no further appointments or operation re-designations. ONE NAME ADDED, not a new appointment: Kaduna now records the GOC 1 Division as Maj Gen Abubakar Sadique Muhammed Wase, 44th GOC and dual-hatted Commander Sector 1 JTF Op Fansan Yamma — he has held the post since August 2025 and was simply missing from this annex; he appears in this week's reporting hosting welfare activity for wounded soldiers in Kaduna. FORMATION-COLUMN UPDATES, all additive and drawn from units named in this week's engagements: (1) Adamawa — OPHK Sector 4 is added with newly inducted 226 Battalion and an Office of the National Security Adviser tactical team, the force named in the official OPHK statement on the 27 August Kopre Mountain assault; the Hong axis WATCH marker is re-cast as a suspected hostage-holding area rather than only a rear area. (2) Borno — 29 Task Force Brigade, 154 Task Force Battalion (Ngamdu, Kaga), 25 Brigade (Damboa) and 82 Division Task Force Battalion (Gwoza) are named, and a WATCH marker is added for the Gubio–Kareto–Damasak corridor after the 3 September anti-armour IED and RPG ambush. (3) Sokoto — COAS Intervention Battalion 7 and 8 Task Force Group Administration Battalion are named under Sector 2 OPFY. (4) Imo — a WATCH marker is added to 34 Artillery Brigade for the Orsu IED, the first anti-armour device

against troops in the South East inside the window. (5) Yobe, Abia and Ebonyi gain the battalion-level units named this week. ONE NAMING CAUTION, and it matters for routing requests: Plateau reporting used Operation ENDURING PEACE and Operation SAFE HAVEN interchangeably for the same numbered sectors within the same week — Sector 8 items appeared under both names. Treat them as one AOR under 3 Armoured Division until the theatre clarifies, and expect the same ambiguity in liaison traffic. ONE UNRESOLVED DISCREPANCY, flagged rather than actioned: at least one party-affiliation aggregator this week lists the PDP as holding Bauchi, Bayelsa and Delta, which conflicts with the 2025 Bayelsa and Delta defections recorded in this table. This annex is unchanged pending a better source; treat the party column in those two rows as lower confidence. The July 2026 force-structure changes remain in transition — expect continuing ambiguity over which headquarters owns a given ground picture or airspace request in the Middle Belt and North Central. Caveats unchanged: ethnic affiliations are as commonly stated in public reporting — several are contested or simplified, and 'Hausa/Fulani' reflects the common compound identification in the far north. Military entries are an indicative open-source ORBAT (division and brigade home locations and operation AORs), not a current disposition — task-force deployments move constantly; verify against your unit's own theatre picture.

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
NORTH EAST				
Borno	Babagana Umara Zulum	APC	Kanuri	HQ 7 Div & OPHK Theatre Comd (Maiduguri); OPHK Sector 3 (Kukawa/Monguno) incl. 101 Special Forces Bn; 212 Bn (Jere); 115 Task Force Bn (Askira-Uba); NEW this issue: 29 Task Force Bde, 154 Task Force Bn (Ngamdu, Kaga), 25 Bde (Damboa), 82 Div Task Force Bn (Gwoza); 81 Div Task Force Bn attached; MNJTF Sector 3 (Baga) — MNJTF ISR cueing strikes on the Lake Chad approaches; NAF air component OPHK (Maiduguri) — WATCH: Gubio–Kareto–Damasak corridor, anti-armour IED plus RPG ambush 3 Sep
Yobe	Mai Mala Buni	APC	Kanuri	OPHK Sector 2 (Damaturu); 120 Task Force Bn (Gujba); 159 Bn (Geidam); task-force brigade elements (Buni Yadi axis)
Adamawa	Ahmadu Umaru Fintiri	APC (defected from PDP, Feb 2026)	Northern-Adamawa minority (Madagali axis); identification varies in public reporting	23 Bde (Yola); NEW: OPHK Sector 4 (Adamawa) with newly inducted 226 Bn, operating with an Office of the NSA tactical team — the force that assaulted Kopre Mountain on 27 Aug. WATCH: Hong / Mandara-fringe axis as a JAS rear area and a suspected hostage-holding area
Bauchi	Bala Mohammed	PDP (opposition)	Fulani	33 Artillery Bde (Shadawanka Barracks, Bauchi)
Gombe	Muhammadu Inuwa	APC	Fulani	Rear-area/support

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
	Yahaya			elements to OPHK
Taraba	Agbu Kefas	APC (defection from PDP announced for Jan 2026)	Jukun	HQ 10 Div (Jalingo) — activated Jul 2026, GOC Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife; 6 Bde (Jalingo); Op Whirl Stroke elements
NORTH WEST				
Kaduna	Uba Sani	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 1 Div (Kaduna) — NEW: GOC named, Maj Gen Abubakar Sadique Muhammed Wase, 44th GOC and dual-hatted Comd Sector 1 JTF Op Fansan Yamma (in post since Aug 2025; previously unnamed in this annex); Nigerian Defence Academy; major NAF bases (Kaduna); 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital — helipad and Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre commissioned 25 Aug 2026 for air CASEVAC of wounded
Kano	Abba Kabir Yusuf	APC (defected from NNPP, 26 Jan 2026)	Hausa/Fulani	3 Bde (Kano)
Katsina	Dikko Umaru Radda	APC	Fulani	17 Bde (Katsina) — Op Fansan Yamma
Kebbi	Nasir Idris	APC	Fulani (Kauran Gwandu)	Elements under 8 Div AOR (Birnin Kebbi garrison)
Sokoto	Ahmed Aliyu	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 8 Div (Sokoto) — Op Fansan Yamma; 28 Special Forces Bde (FOB Sifawa, FOB Shagari); 8 Div Strike Team; NEW: COAS Intervention Bn 7 and 8 Task Force Group Administration Bn under Sector 2 OPFY (PKT machine gun recovery, Rabah)
Zamfara	Dauda Lawal	APC (defected from PDP, Mar 2026)	Hausa	1 Bde (Gusau); OPFY Sector 2
Jigawa	Umar Namadi	APC	Hausa/Fulani	Elements under 3 Bde (Kano) AOR
NORTH CENTRAL				
Plateau	Caleb Mutfwang	APC (defected from PDP, late 2025)	Mwaghavul	HQ 3 Armoured Div (Jos); Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP) — Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, sectors numbered 1–8 with sub-sectors; CAUTION this issue: reporting used OPEP and Op SAFE HAVEN interchangeably for the same sectors in the same week (e.g. Sector 8 items appear under both) — treat the two names as one AOR when routing a request; state-level Op Rainbow alongside
Benue	Hyacinth Alia	APC	Tiv	HQ 5 Div (Makurdi) — GOC Maj Gen Moses Gara, dual-hatted Comd Op Whirl Stroke (Jul

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				2026); 11 Bde (Gboko); 72 Special Forces Bn (Makurdi); Operation Zenda (state-level, criticised over the Ayilamo clearance 27 Aug); NAF Tactical Air Command HQ (Makurdi)
Niger	Mohammed Umaru Bago	APC	Nupe	31 Artillery Bde (Minna); Army TRADOC (Minna); 29 Bde (Kainji) — WATCH: Lakurawa operational leadership assessed by ISS to be based in Borgu LGA; Op Savannah Shield active in Mariga LGA this week
Kwara	AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq	APC	Yoruba (Ilorin)	HQ 9 Div (Ilorin) — GOC Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, dual-hatted Comd Op Savannah Shield (Jul 2026); Sobi Barracks garrison
Kogi	Ahmed Usman Ododo	APC	Ebira	Garrison elements (Lokoja); confluence-axis security ops; joint ops under 2 Div AOR (western Kogi)
Nasarawa	Abdullahi Sule	APC	Hausa	10 Bde (Lafia); Op Whirl Stroke elements (Lafia axis)
FCT Abuja	— (administered by FCT Minister Nyesom Wike)	APC-aligned (Wike ex-PDP)	Ikwerre (minister)	Guards Bde (Abuja); Defence HQ & Service HQs; NAF HQ
SOUTH EAST				
Abia	Alex Otti	Labour Party (opposition)	Igbo	14 Bde (Ohafia); 144 Bn (Aba South)
Anambra	Charles Soludo (re-elected Nov 2025)	APGA (opposition, APC-aligned)	Igbo	302 Artillery Regt (Onitsha); 15 Bde — established Jul 2026 under JTF South East / Op UDO KA; led the 15 and 22 Aug Anambra camp raids
Ebonyi	Francis Nwifuru	APC	Igbo	Elements under 82 Div AOR (Abakaliki); 24 Special Engineer Regt
Enugu	Peter Mbah	APC (defected from PDP)	Igbo	HQ 82 Composite Div (Enugu)
Imo	Hope Uzodinma	APC	Igbo	34 Artillery Bde (Obinze, Owerri) — WATCH: first anti-armour IED against troops in the SE inside the window, detonated under an MRAP on the Ihite Ukwu—Health Centre axis, Orsu LGA, 4 Sep; Orsu sits on the Imo—Anambra ESN seam next to the Ihiala axis
SOUTH SOUTH				
Rivers	Siminalayi Fubara (reinstated Sep 2025 after emergency rule)	APC (reported defection from PDP, Dec 2025)	Ijaw (Opobo/Nkoro)	HQ 6 Div (Port Harcourt); JTF Op Delta Safe; NNS Pathfinder
Bayelsa	Douye Diri	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ijaw	16 Bde (Yenagoa)

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
Delta	Sheriff Oborevori	APC (defected from PDP, May 2025)	Okpe (Urhobo)	63 Bde (Asaba); Op Delta Safe elements
Edo	Monday Okpebholo (elected Sep 2024)	APC	Esan	CORRECTION: HQ 83 Div (Benin City) — established Jul 2026 in the force expansion, omitted from earlier issues of this annex; 4 Bde (Benin City)
Akwa Ibom	Umo Eno	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ibibio	2 Bde (Uyo)
Cross River	Bassey Otu	APC	Efik	13 Bde (Calabar); Navy Eastern Command (Calabar) — anti-piracy / oil-theft offensive announced 21 Aug 2026, continuing
SOUTH WEST				
Lagos	Babajide Sanwo-Olu	APC	Yoruba	HQ 81 Div (Lagos); Navy Western Command
Ogun	Dapo Abiodun	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 81 Div AOR
Oyo	Seyi Makinde	PDP (opposition)	Yoruba	HQ 2 Div (Ibadan) — GOC Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda (Jul 2026)
Osun	Ademola Adeleke (re-elected 15 Aug 2026 — second term)	Accord Party — left PDP Dec 2025; re-elected 15 Aug 2026 with 511,067 votes vs APC 444,815; an APC-defection rumour was denied by his camp in late August	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR
Ondo	Lucky Aiyedatiwa (elected Nov 2024)	APC	Yoruba (Ilaje)	32 Artillery Bde (Akure/Owena)
Ekiti	Biodun Oyebanji	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR (Ado-Ekiti garrison)

Changes to watch: another quiet week for the annex itself — no gubernatorial changes, no defections, no new GOC appointments, no operation re-designations. The substantive additions are the units named in this week's fighting: OPHK Sector 4 in Adamawa with newly inducted 226 Battalion and an ONSA tactical team, which is the force actually looking for the Mussa and Lassa children; 29 Task Force Brigade and 154 Task Force Battalion in Borno; COAS Intervention Battalion 7 in Sokoto; and 34 Artillery Brigade in Imo, which now owns a live IED problem in Orsu. The two items to carry forward for routing purposes are the OPEP / Op SAFE HAVEN naming overlap in Plateau and the continuing July 2026 divisional transition. Watch items carried forward: the western corridor, where 29 Bde (Kainji) and 9 Div (Ilorin) are nine weeks old and Lakurawa's leadership is assessed to sit in Borgu; the Hong / Kopre Mountain axis in Adamawa under 23 Bde and Sector 4; a Rivers relapse (Fubara–Wike tension); and Operation Zenda in Benue, still under public criticism after the Ayilamo clearance. Formation notes most relevant to the air mission are unchanged: 7 Div / OPHK (Maiduguri) is the supported command in the North East, with MNJTF ISR cueing strikes on the Lake Chad approaches; 8 Div (Sokoto) and 1 Div (Kaduna) run the North West under Op Fansan Yamma; 3 Armoured Div (Jos) runs OPEP; NAF Tactical Air Command HQ is Makurdi, co-located with the new 5 Div HQ; and 44 NARH Kaduna is the North West casualty-receiving site with a commissioned helipad since 25 August.

Reminder: This is open-source orientation only and is not a substitute for current in-theatre intelligence. Verify all specifics against your unit's authoritative reporting before acting on them operationally.